

Three Pillars of Success

Understanding in Depth

Surface-level knowledge won't cut it anymore. You need to understand not just how to use AI tools, but how they actually work under the hood.

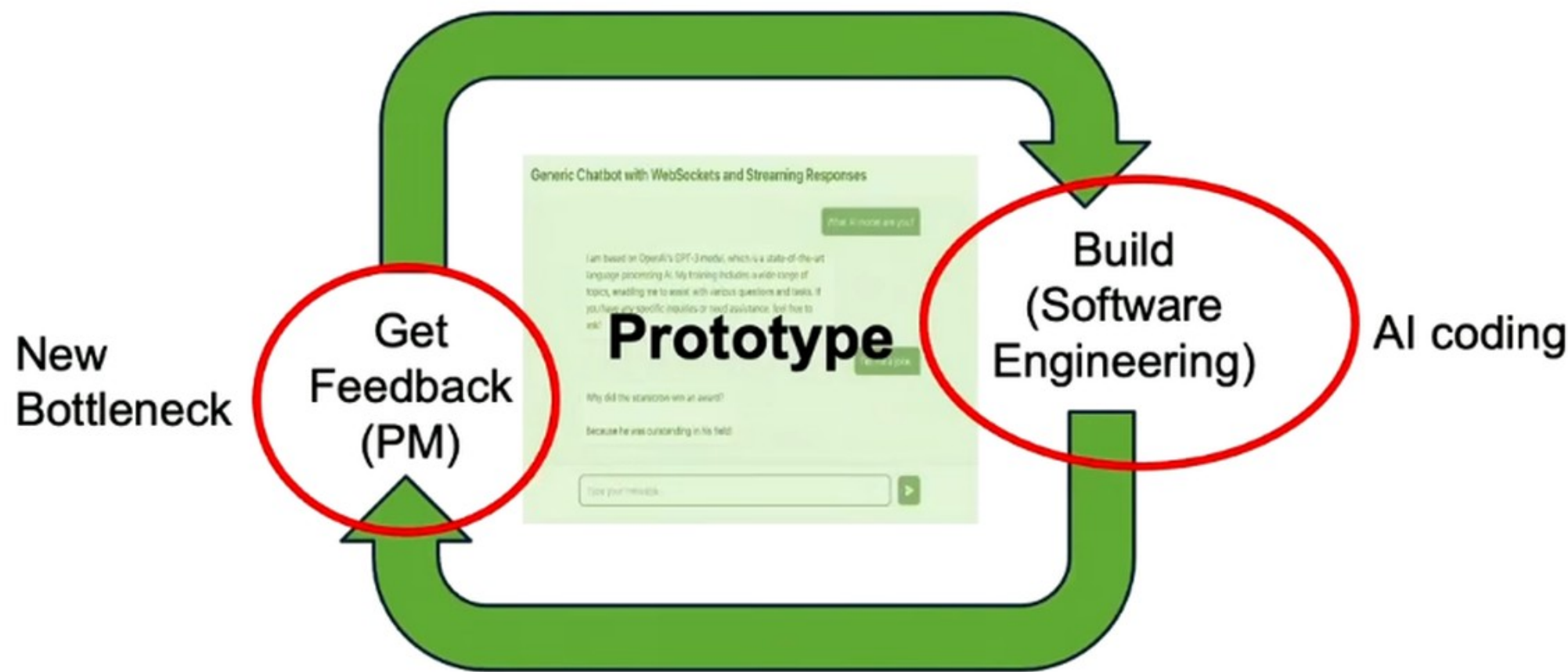
Business Focus

Technical skills matter, but understanding business value matters more. Can you translate AI capabilities into real business outcomes?

Bias Towards Delivery

Ideas are cheap. Execution is everything. Show that you can ship working solutions, not just impressive demos.

Building at speed: The Product Management Bottleneck



- Engineer:PM ratio trending toward downward, even to 1:1
- Engineers that can shape product move really fast

The Reality of AI Work Today

Working in AI today looks very different from the glossy recruitment videos. It's less about pushing boundaries of what's possible and more about making AI work reliably in production. You'll spend more time thinking about edge cases, failure modes, and user experience than you will training cutting-edge models.

The field has matured from "build cool things" to "build *useful* things." This shift actually creates opportunity for pragmatic, business-minded graduates who can bridge the gap between possibility and practicality.

The Business Focus Advantage



Companies aren't looking for AI researchers (unless you're applying to research labs). They're looking for people who can identify where AI adds value and execute on that vision.

This means: Understanding customer problems before jumping to solutions. Knowing when AI is the right tool and when it isn't. Being able to communicate technical concepts to non-technical stakeholders.

Your computer science degree taught you algorithms. Now you need to learn business value.

Good Technical Debt from AI Coding

✓ Clear Objectives Met

You knew what you needed to build, AI helped you build it faster. The solution directly addresses a specific requirement.

✓ Business Value Delivered

The code solves a real problem for real users. You can articulate the value it creates in business terms, not just technical ones.

✓ Human Understanding

You and your team understand how the code works. It's been reviewed by actual humans. Documentation exists and makes sense.

Bad Technical Debt from AI Coding

1

Unclear Value

The classic "solution looking for a problem." You built something because you could, not because anyone needed it. No clear user or business case.

2

Spaghetti Code

Poorly structured, difficult to follow, brittle. Nobody really understands how it works. Debugging is nearly impossible. Changes break things in unexpected ways.

3

Authority Over Merit

The solution was adopted because of *who* built it, not because of its quality. No one can explain *why* or *how* it works. Questioning it feels political.

Recent Hype Examples

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"Software Engineering is Dead"

Claimed AI would replace all developers within months. Reality: Demand for skilled engineers has never been higher, but the skills required are evolving.

”

“

"Hollywood is Dead"

Text-to-video will eliminate the entire film industry. Reality: Creative professionals are using AI as another tool, not being replaced by it.

”

“

"AGI by Year-End"

Artificial General Intelligence is imminent. Reality: We've made impressive progress on narrow tasks, but true AGI remains distant.

”

Practical Hype Navigation Strategy



Filter Actively

Develop trusted sources. Ignore engagement metrics. Look for substance over style.



Go Deep on Fundamentals

When a trend emerges, understand the underlying tech before judging its impact.



Keep Your Finger on the Pulse

Stay aware of trends without being consumed by them. Know what's hot and why.

Example: When "AI agents" became the hot topic, most people chased implementations. The valuable skill was understanding *when* agentic approaches add value and when they don't.

Opportunities and Risks Ahead

The AI field right now is full of genuine opportunity. Companies across every industry need people who can implement AI effectively. New applications and use cases emerge constantly. The technology itself keeps improving at a rapid pace.

But there's an iceberg ahead, and it's called a bubble.

Massive investment has poured into AI with expectations of equally massive returns. Some of those bets will pay off spectacularly. Many won't. When reality doesn't match the hype, there will be a correction. Companies will fail. Funding will dry up. Jobs will disappear.

Your goal is to position yourself to weather the correction and thrive afterward.

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Anatomy of the Current Bubble



The pyramid shows the structure of today's AI market. There's real value at the base, but it's supporting an enormous weight of speculation, imitation, and inflated expectations. When the weight becomes too much, things will topple.

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Avoiding the Bubble Impact

1 Focus on Fundamental Skills

Technical trends come and go. Deep understanding of CS fundamentals, system design, and software engineering principles will always be valuable.

2 Build Real Solutions

Work on projects that solve actual problems, not just demonstrations of what's possible. Build things people will pay for.

3 Understand the Business Side

When budgets get cut, people who can articulate business value survive. Those who can only talk about technical innovation don't.

4 Diversify Your Skills

Don't put all your eggs in one AI basket. Be valuable even if the AI hype completely deflates tomorrow.



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When Bubbles Burst: The Fallout

What Happens

- Funding evaporates overnight
- Startups fold rapidly
- Hiring freezes become layoffs
- Projects get cancelled
- Talent floods the market

Who Survives

- People with proven delivery records
- Those who understand business value
- Engineers with deep fundamentals
- Professionals with diverse skills
- Team players who ship products

The dot-com crash of 2000 and the crypto winter of 2022 offer lessons. Speculation collapses, but genuine value remains. Position yourself on the value side.

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